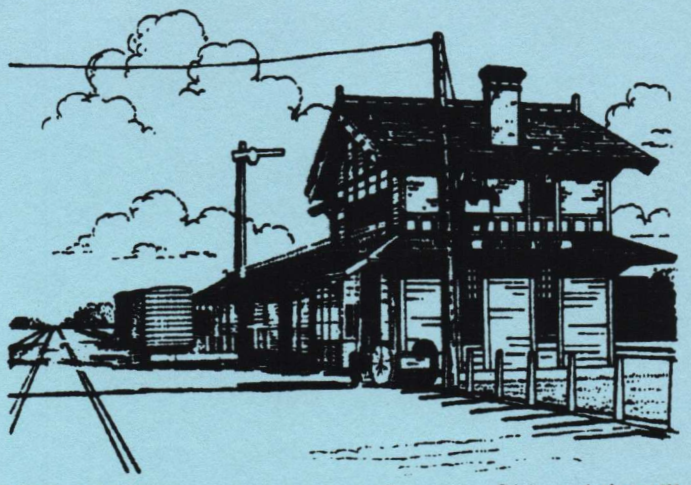
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

El Camino Hospital And the Practice of Medicine After WW II
The May 1998 Meeting

Our speaker for the May 3, 1998 meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association will be Dr. H.M. [Hugh] Upton, M.D. Dr. Upton did his residency at the USN Hospital Mare Island and at the San Mateo Community Hospital. He established his practice in the Los Altos–Mountain View area in the early 1950's and has practiced here ever since with his special interest being in family medicine.

In the mid 1950's he became aware of the acute need for a central medical facility in the Mountain View area and became involved in the early committee work which led to the creation of the El Camino Hospital District and eventually the development of El Camino Hospital, one of the premier medical facilities of the entire Bay Area.

Dr. Upton has served as Chief of Staff for the Hospital and continuously on various Committees and Task Forces overseeing the operation of the hospital.

Dr. Upton will talk about the early days in creating the El Camino Hospital, and the medical, economic and political environment surrounding this fine institution.

Community Action Your Police At Work
The February 1998 Meeting

At the February meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association, Sergeant Richard Elias, Community Action and Information Officer for the Mountain View Police Department gave us an excellent overview of the history and development of Mountain View's Police Department. He shared with us a wealth of old pictures and documents which called up many memories from the audience.

Sergeant Elias spoke at some length about the concept of *Community Policing* and about the *Citizens Police Academy*.

Community Policing is an effort to get the public more involved with the Police Department and to build a partnership for policing the community. The Citizens Police Academy is a major effort at building a closer relationship and greater understanding between the people and their police.

It was a very interesting a provocative meeting.

Fremont Fire District
by Carol Fischer

Two fire districts in Mountain View? Well, not exactly. In 1928, the Fremont Fire District was formed to protect those areas on the outskirts of Mountain View not within the sphere of the established Mountain View Fire Department. This area also included the unincorporated land of Los Altos and Los Altos Hills. The new district was accountable to the Santa Clara County Board of Supervisors. The manpower was completely volunteer. The men were proud of their new American La France pumper which was capable of pumping 500 gallons per minute. Shortly after the district was formed, the company responded to an explosion of a Prohibition still in a two-story house on Jordan and San Antonio Road. Although the volunteers couldn't save that house, they were more successful at extinguishing a nearby grass fire on Mariposa Avenue. Thus began the accomplishments of the new Fremont Fire District.

As Mountain view grew and began annexing more land, it was often thought that the two districts would merge. However, by 1977, the Fremont District was still in existence as an all-volunteer department. The firefighters were very excited because the district had just purchased a $46,000 American La France fire engine from the La France factory in Elmira, New York. Because the department was a frugal and resourceful one, they decided to save funds by driving the new engine back to Mountain View rather than paying someone else to do it. The adventure began in New York for Captain Will Radcliff and fireman Brad Lutts on April 26th. The men drove in shifts, making about 600 miles a day. Since the engine drove better when fully loaded, it was filled with 750 gallons of water. Radcliff and Lutts decided to fight any fires they might spot along the way. They certainly got strange looks from the locals whenever the showed up at a fire! The two made stops in Fremont, Ohio and Mountain View, Wyoming. The latter station was nothing but an old barn spray-painted "Fire Station" on the side. The only mishap occurred in Reno Nevada when the windshield wipers broke. While being repaired, the men spent their time playing the slot machines. What impressed the local citizenry the most during the journey? The engine's capacity to take on gas. Radcliff quipped, "We filled up at one gas station and made the attendant happier than he had ever been in his life!" The new La France arrived safe and sound in Mountain View on May 2, 1977. After more than 3,000 miles, Radcliff and Lutts were glad to be home but were pleased that they had undertaken such a unique odyssey.

By 1982, the Fremont Fire District remained small but active: however it was shrinking in size. It was estimated that there were only 400 residents in nine small pockets of unincorporated land. This area included the region now known as North Bayshore and parts of Mountain View bordering Los Altos. At the time there were 22 volunteer firefighters who received no pay but a minimal $5.00 for each response they attended. The Mountain View Fire Department felt they would trouble responding to the fires in the Fremont District without additional manpower or operational costs. So it was in August of 1982 that the Fremont Fire District ended 54 years of dedication to the Mountain View/Los Altos area. Local residents should feel proud of this tiny, independent district whose firefighters cared enough to volunteer their services as well as to drive their new fire engine across the country home to Mountain View!

Street Talk

Would you, our readers, be interested in contributing questions, comments and information about names of streets, past or present, in Mountain View? If you would, send your information to the Newsletter Editor (name and address are on the front page) and we will convert your ideas into a little quiz for the rest of us! Here is a question contributed by Barbara Kinchen.

In the early 1960s Mountain View had a Curling Avenue. Where was its location and for what was it named?

Old Newspaper Items by Barbara Kinchen

75 Years Ago (1923): Fire at the Firehouse! A few hours after their regular meeting, firemen were called back to extinguish a fire which had started in the sawdust on the floor.

Prick by a rose thorn caused the blood poisoning death of a local lady.

"Marriage is a great leveler – of income."

Seven students comprised the first graduating class from Mountain View Academy (Seventh Day Adventist High School) while Mountain View High School presented diplomas to twenty-seven students, the largest class in the history of the school.

South Shore Port, at the end of Whisman Road, formally opened with inspection of the facilities and bay trips on the new boat, South Shore.

Children paid 15¢ and adults 35¢ to see Mr. And Mrs. Martin Johnson's "Trailing Africa Wild Animals" at the Glen Theatre.

The Ehrhorn orchard, 48 acres bounded by Castro Street, Church Street, Calderon Avenue and El Camino Real, sold first to Tom Hom, was divided into three parcels and resold. W.B. Boulter purchased the Castro Street portion, George Glumaz the middle third and A.D. Rice the Calderon Avenue end. Ehrhorn Avenue has been laid out and View and Hope Streets are to be opened from Church Street to the Highway.

The local American Legion post celebrated Memorial Day by decorating graves followed by dedicating ceremonies on Jake Mockbee's property at Paradiso on Stevens Creek. A bronze tablet was fastened to a redwood tree in memory of Leon Robart, the "only Mountain View boy who made the supreme sacrifice overseas."

50 years ago (1948): Children found an "old tin box" containing interesting papers in an Alviso orchard. They had discovered the stolen safe from Guerrero's Stierlin Road grocery store. Thieves had taken the cash but not the $1400 in government bonds or the $800 in checks which the kids were using to play store.

Mountain View sold the American La France pumper, used by the Fire Department for a quarter-century, to Chambers Lodge, Lake Tahoe, for $750. The resort intended to convert the truck into a tank wagon.

Miss Gertrude Lewis was honored guest for dinner at L'Omelette in celebration of her twenty-five years employment at Bank of America.

Both the Mexican-American Club and La Estella Club participated in San Jose's Cinco de Mayo parade and program.

From the grocery store ads: Sunshine crackers 23¢ for one pound box; ten pounds Holly sugar 85¢; three packages Jell-O 22¢.

Phone numbers got longer with the addition of the prefix YO 7. (Yorkshire)

Participating in the KNBC broadcast of Quiz Kid's Best Teacher Contest were Gail Newfarmer and the teacher she had for second grade at Dana Street School, Mrs. Bess (Beller) Hardy Sifert.

The American Legion Auxiliary sponsored its annual Poppy Poster Contest at local Schools and sold poppies, collecting over $400 which would be used for child welfare and rehabilitation work at Palo Alto Veterans Administration Hospital.

Mountain View High School's class of 1948 numbered 141.

An Eagles Auxiliary organized and initiated 41 members. Also newly organized, Junior Rifle Club for boys and girls under 18 and devoted to various phases of target shooting.

The Mountain View Park Beer Garden and Family Picnic Grounds just opened at the corner of Stierlin and Plymouth Roads.

Groundbreaking ceremonies were held for the $50,000 Sunnyview Family Club on Esquela

Avenue. (Now the Senior Center).

25 Years Ago (1973): The Downtown Revitalization Committee has chosen 'Castro Square' as the name for the downtown shopping area.

John O'Holloran, City Manager since 1958, left to become General Manager of Santa Clara County Flood Control and Water District. Assistant City Manager Vern Hazen will serve as acting manager while the city seeks a replacement for O'Halloran.

A plaque honoring those missing in the Vietnam conflict was placed at the foot of a live oak tree in Pioneer Park.

John Cappalletti proposed an 80-unit apartment for retired people. Studios would rent for $500 a month and one-bedroom apartments for $750, including all meals and services. (Redwood Villa on Montecito Avenue)

Moffett Field celebrated its 40th birthday. The field was commissioned on April 12, 1933 and has grown from the small base housing a dirigible, the Macon, to one of the country's nerve centers for antisubmarine warfare.

Tragedy struck April 13, 1973 when two large planes collided in midair while landing at Moffett. A Navy P3 Orion and a Convair 990 jet flying laboratory carrying eight NASA scientists, crashed in flames onto the Sunnyvale Municipal Golf Course. Sixteen were killed and one airman survived.

New to the Mountain View History Center

From Ann Cozzolino: 8 ½ x 11 colored photo of Mountain View High School on Castro Street.

From June Redwine de Larios: Postcard mailed from Mountain View in 1915 by June's father to his future bride in Texas. The card shows the newly erected electric sign at Castro Street and the railroad and members of the Boosters' Club in wonderful open touring cars.

From Doris Awalt Ebere: 10 x 13 copy of a photo from her collection, the same as on the postcard described above. Chester F. Awalt, Doris' father, is one of the "Boosters".

From Ruth Job Erichsen: 1915 Graduation Program for Mountain View High School.

Undated postcard with message from Mrs. Virginia Crittenden (1838-1924) to Ruth's aunt, Winona Stevens.

Postcard showing a group of ladies in long white dresses and white hats marching and carrying a sign reading, "War Comfort Committee Christian Scientists." Dresses would date this as WW I era. This was not taken in Mountain View as railroad or streetcar tracks are shown down the middle of a commercial street.

From Bill Henderson: Several 3¢ and 5¢ postcards issued by the post office.

Official Program Booklets for the Harvest Festivals held in Mountain View in 1950 and 1951. These events were sponsored by the Chamber of Commerce. The booklets contain many pictures of local people and businesses.

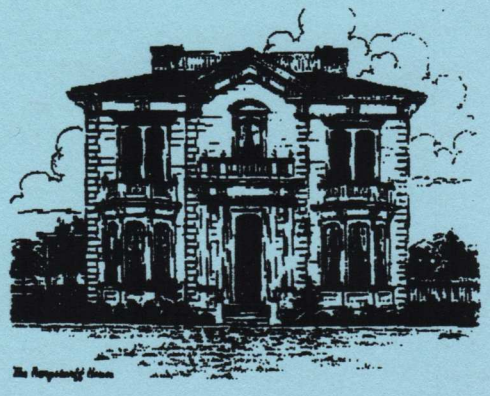
Abstract of Title dated 1918 with information on a property in the Mockbee – Weilheimer Addition which is just north of the train tracks.

From Craig & Marjorie Holden: 11 pages of genealogical information on the Booher family.

From Jim Lyons: Mountain View Register published April 20, 1906, with stories of the earthquake damages due to the April 18th great earthquake of 1906.

Portion of Daily Palo Alto Times of March 6, 1912 showing a map of Palo Alto.

Mr. Lyons has just retired from his business of Historical Newspapers.



History of Mountain View

The Mountain View Historical Association Executive Committee is exploring the idea of commissioning the creation of a *History of Mountain View*. Your executive committee has appointed a subcommittee with the goal of publishing the *History of Mountain View* by the year 2002 (the 100th anniversary of the city) or possibly sooner. The committee consists of our City Historian, Barbara McPheeters Kinchen, Trudy Herrero Odbert, Margaret Vidovich and Wally Erichsen as Chairman. Initial activity involves study of some typical local history books of nearby cities and formulation of coverage quality and objectiveness.

The Committee has met with Kathleen Peregrine, Director of the California History Center at DeAnza College and Mary Jo Ignoffo, author of the book on the history of Sunnyvale, to establish the possibility of help from professional historians in writing and publishing such a book.

Preliminary thoughts are that the book should be well illustrated and factual, and should relate the history of the Mountain View area from prehistoric times up to the present. Input as to content and style will be welcomed by the members of the committee.

MVHA members who have important historical photographs or stories can be of help to us in the preparation of the book. Please contact a member of the committee and let us know what you have.

Executive Committee Meetings

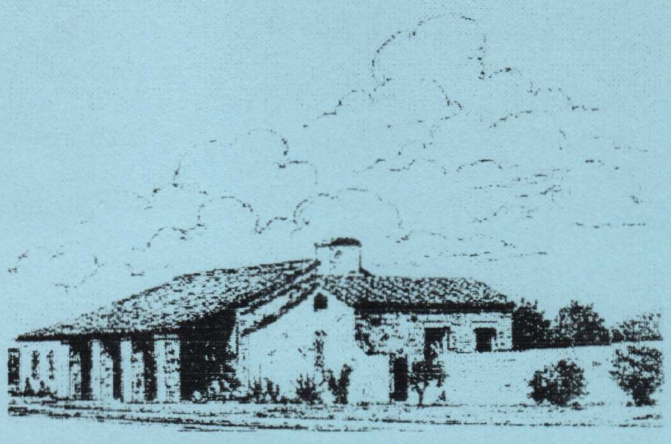
The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association has met several times since the last regular meeting. Major topics have been the continuing effort to *Save the Adobe*, concerns over the conservation and preservation of the historical belongings of the Association, planning for our meetings, and our latest project, the creation of a *History of Mountain View*.

Your Editor would like to take this opportunity to review the last year's efforts. Life Memberships in the Association have increased from 46 to 59 while total Members have increased from 250 to 271. Our Treasury has grown from $8,394 to $12,899. We participated in a major way in the City's 95th Birday Celebration, and in the opening of the new Library and the operation of the *Mountain View History Center*. We are committed to making a significant contribution to the City's 100th Anniversary Celibration.

The Mountain View Historical Association is a real part of the social and cultural establishment in Mountain View. We could use more help in carrying out our various projects. If you would like to meet and work with interesting people on interesting projects let any of the officers of the Association know and we will put you to work.

Mountain View History Center
(formerly the Pioneer Room)
New Schedule:
Tuesday – Thursday – Saturday
1–5 P.M.
Wednesday
5-9 P.M.

SAVE THE ADOBE



The Mountain View Historical Association acknowledges with thanks the support of the following persons who have contributed to our efforts to ***Save the Adobe!***

Lorena Anderson
Marge Bailey
Carol Baumgartner
James "max" Bellew
Dena Bonnell
Michael Bucini
James Dale
Cliff Del Carlo
Doris Ebere
Ruth Erichsen
Wally Erichsen
Jack Evans
Betty Fahs
Carmen and Ralph Faravelli
Virginia Farwell
William Garlipp
Bea Grass
Marion Grimm
William V. Henderson
George Holden
George Jagels
David Kay
Laura Laut
Don Lawson
Betty Mc Laren
Al Miller
Gail Urban Moore
Mini Mourkas
Helen Newfarmer
Shirley Newfarmer
Dolores Panaligan
Margaret Peterson
Sam Polizzi
Patricia Reyburn
Margaret Garliepp Sideroff
Peter Spily
Honor Spitz
John K. Stoddard
Linda Swan
Joe and Roberta Sweeney
Charles Thompson
Edna Thompson
Bettie Togami
Celentine Traverso
Frances Trimmer
Barbara Welsh
Hal Zangari
Mary Lou Zoglin

In Memory of:

Jane and Andy Hingsberger
Benny Sanchez
Robert Schatz

The Mountain View City Council has taken the fate of the Adobe Building under study. Over the next few weeks, matters of the possible uses of a restored facility, costs of restoration, community interest and the historic and artistic value of the building will be considered. At this time it appears likely that the City will take some action to restore and revitalize the building. Nothing is yet firm, and there are many programs and facilities competing for the available funds. We will of course keep pressing the issue, and we are hopeful of a favorable outcome.

SAVE THE ADOBE

Membership Report
by Edna Thompson

A list of members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Life Members	59
Special Members	2
Honored Member	1
Individual & Family Members	209
Total	271

New Members:

Dorothy M. DeDontney
Thomas E. Miller
Austin and Eleanor Spencer
Leo B. Wilkes

New Life Members:

Godfrey Baumgartner
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Anne G. Nichols
John P. Puppo

Life Members

Mario Ambra
Godfrey Baumgartner
Dena K. Bonnell
Hilton Brown
Reynolds Camp
Cliff Del Carlo
Alfred P. Chasuk
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Farvelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Carole Fischer
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
DeWitt Hogle
Norene Hogle
Alice D. Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
George Jagels
Al Jehning
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Kenneth Richard Malovos
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Anne G. Nichols
Milan Popovich
John P. Puppo
Patricia J. Reyburn
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Martin J. Spangler
Honor Spitz
J. R. Stafford
Brigitte Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson
Sally Moore Taboada
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Denise Williams
Bill Wissell

Association Officers and Board Members

President	Ralph Faravell
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President	Arthur Walton
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	June de Larios
Membership	Edna Thompson
Newsletter & Program	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Mary Esther Walton
Memorial/Remembrance	Margaret Peterson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

Treasurer's Report
A. J. De Larios

Balance 1/1/98		$12,899.22
Income:		
Membership	799.00	
Sales	84.00	
Adobe Fund	0.00	
Memorial Fund	0.00	
Interest	16.50	
Total Income		..... 899.50
Expense:		
Administration	341.56	
Adobe Fund	19.82	
Total Expense		..... 361.38
Balance 3/31/98		$13,437.34

Fund Banances:

Adobe Fund	2,604.32
Memorial Fund	275.00
Life Member Fund	5,900.00
General Fund	4658.02

Investment:

CD, $5,000 -- 5.400% – Matures 7/98
CD, $5,000 – 5.400% – Matures 7/98

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

REGULAR MEETING

Sunday, May 3, 1998
2:00 PM
Senior Center - 266 Escuela

Topic and Speaker

El Camino Hospital and the Practice of Medicine After WW II

Presented by
Dr. H.M. [Hugh] Upton

MEMBERSHIP: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW____ RENEWAL____

Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

Make Check Payable to:

Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

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P.O. BOX 252
MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042

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